

Basics4AI — A Guide for Schools and Teachers

A plain-language introduction to the Basics4AI platform. No technical background required.

What is Basics4AI?

Basics4AI is a web-based program that teaches students the basics of artificial intelligence (AI) — what it is, how it works, and how to think about it critically. Students work through a series of short, self-paced learning modules directly in their web browser, on any computer or tablet with internet access — no software to install.

Each module combines short lessons with simple activities: multiple-choice questions to check understanding, brief surveys about the student's experience, and short written reflections. There's nothing to grade by hand — the platform tracks progress and scores automatically.

Basics4AI was built as part of a research study into how young learners engage with AI education, so it also includes tools that let researchers and teachers see how a class or cohort is progressing, without adding any extra work for the classroom.

Who Uses the Platform

There are three types of accounts:

Students — work through the modules in order. They see only their own activities and progress; they cannot see any other student's information.

Teachers — get a dashboard summarizing how their students are doing: who's completed which modules, overall trends, and summary statistics. Teachers cannot change any student's data or account.

Administrators — manage accounts (approving new registrations, resetting passwords if a student forgets theirs), and handle behind-the-scenes technical maintenance. In most school deployments, this role is held by the research team or a designated point of contact, not classroom staff.

Getting Started

1. **Registration.** A new user creates an account with a username and password — no email address or personal information is required to sign up.

2. **Approval.** New accounts don't work immediately. An administrator reviews and approves each registration before the account can log in — this prevents unauthorized access and lets the school control exactly who's enrolled.
3. **First login.** Once approved, the student (or teacher) logs in and is taken straight to their dashboard.

If a student forgets their password, an administrator can reset it — there's no lockout period they need to wait out.

How Students Move Through the Program

The modules are presented in a fixed order — think of it like chapters in a book. A student can see every module's title, but only the current one is actually open to work on:

-  **Completed** — the student has finished this module.
-  **Available now** — this is the module the student should be working on.
-  **Locked** — comes later; unlocks automatically once the previous module is completed.

This sequencing is intentional and automatic — a student can't skip ahead, and a teacher doesn't need to manually unlock anything. If a school's schedule doesn't allow time for every module in a given term, a module can be temporarily paused for that group without losing any of the content or any data already collected — it simply isn't shown to students until it's turned back on for a future group.

Each module typically takes under an hour and includes:

- A short lesson.
- A quick multiple-choice check for understanding.
- A brief survey about the student's experience with the material.
- A short written reflection question or two.

Everything a student submits is saved automatically as they go — there's no separate "save" step, and no risk of losing work partway through.

What Teachers Can See

The Teacher Dashboard gives a bird's-eye view of a class or cohort's progress: who's completed what, how the group is performing overall on the knowledge checks, and general trends over time. It's built for a teacher to check in periodically, not something that requires daily use.

Teachers do not see individual answers in a way that's tied to a real name — students are identified by their account username within the dashboard, and the dashboard is designed for understanding group-level patterns rather than policing individual students.

Data Privacy & Handling

A few things worth knowing about how student information is handled:

- **No names, email addresses, or other personal contact information are collected by the platform.** Accounts use a username and password only.
- **Access is role-based.** A student can only ever see their own activity — never another student's. Only approved administrators can manage accounts or perform maintenance actions, and every such action is logged.
- **Sessions are secure.** Logging out fully ends a session; using the browser's "back" button after logging out does not restore access.
- **New accounts require explicit approval** before they can be used — nothing is open to the public without a school or research team first approving it.
- **Participation is consent-based.** For research pilots, participation requires the appropriate parental consent and student assent to be collected first, entirely outside the platform, before an account is ever created for a student.

If your school or institution has specific data-handling or compliance questions (e.g. for an IRB or privacy review), the research team maintains a more detailed technical data security protocol and can walk through it directly — this guide covers what's true in everyday practice, not a full compliance audit.

Getting Help

If something isn't working as expected — a student can't log in, a module doesn't seem to be unlocking, or anything else looks off — reach out to your school's platform administrator or the research team point of contact. Most issues (a forgotten password, a stuck-looking dashboard) can be resolved in a couple of minutes without needing any technical knowledge on your end.